MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer transitioning to DevOps / Platform Engineering
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including two years focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Hands-on experience owning GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and building Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster. Personal infrastructure work includes a k3s homelab, Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure and introductory AWS learning. Seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure and platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; k3s homelab), Helm, Terraform (personal projects), Ansible (basic), Linux
Monitoring and data: Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Programming and testing: Python, Bash, Java (test code), pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Cloud learning: AWS (EC2 and S3 basics)
Other: Git, Argo CD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021-present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering builds, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster, including application services, PostgreSQL and seeded data; environments are removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of about 900 tests.
- Built a flaky-test dashboard using Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana and the GitLab API; the flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams addressed the top offenders.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data and documented how the CI system works for team onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019-2021

- Tested web and mobile applications through manual and automated testing for client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018-2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024-2025

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, plus Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam, scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)